

MARKET PULSE · WEEKLY TRADING REPORT

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Sunday 17 May 2026

OUTLOOK · NEUTRAL-BEARISH

MACRO THEME

Moody's strips US of last Aaa rating (downgrades to Aa1) as April CPI +3.8% YoY cements Fed hold. NAS100 hit year high 29,678 on Trump-Xi Beijing summit before Friday reversal. Silver crashed 14% from 88.88 peak. NVDA earnings Thu May 22 is the pivotal forward catalyst.

OVERVIEW

Week of May 11-17 defined by two competing forces: risk-on optimism from Trump's Beijing summit with Xi Jinping driving NAS100 to year high 29,678 and Dow above 50,000 (May 14), versus inflation shock from April CPI +3.8% YoY (highest since May 2023). By Friday May 15 the inflation side won: US 10-year yield jumped to 4.544% (highest in nearly a year), silver fell 7% on the day, and gold sold off from its 4,765 peak. Late Friday Moody's downgraded US sovereign debt from Aaa to Aa1, citing ballooning deficits. The downgrade is the dominant Monday open story: dollar under pressure, gold supported, equities facing another leg of selling. NVDA Q1 earnings Thursday May 22 remains the most pivotal equity catalyst for the period.

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LIVE MARKET DATA

INSTRUMENT	PRICE	DAY CHG %	DAY RANGE	52W RANGE	SIGNAL
US30	49,364	-0.65%	49,245 – 49,697	41,354 – 50,513	NEU-BEAR
NAS100	28,819	-0.61%	28,567 – 29,032	20,778 – 29,679	NEU-BULL
GER40	24,428	-0.03%	24,288 – 24,431	21,864 – 25,508	NEU-BEAR
AUDUSD	0.7115	+0.07%	0.7091 – 0.7118	0.6374 – 0.7277	NEU-BULL
GBPCAD	1.8430	+0.11%	1.8396 – 1.8443	1.8018 – 1.8915	NEU-BEAR
XAGUSD	75.80	+2.65%	73.39 – 75.87	32.66 – 121.30	NEU-BEAR
XAUUSD	4,484	+0.38%	4,455 – 4,512	3,242 – 5,586	NEUTRAL

SCORECARD VS PREVIOUS REPORT

INSTRUMENT	PREVIOUS BIAS	RESULT	VERDICT
US30	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	Broke 50,000 intraday May 14 (high 50,200, close 50,063) — reversed -537pts Fri to 49,526; failed to hold the break	PARTIALLY
NAS100	BULLISH	Year high 29,678 hit May 14 on US-China trade optimism; reversed Fri on hot CPI and 10yr yield surge to close 29,125 (-0.37% week)	PARTIALLY
GER40	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	-1.60% on week from 24,338 to 23,950; steady decline on global yield rise and ECB June 11 live hike risk	CORRECT
AUDUSD	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	Cleared 0.7200 target (peak 0.7271 May 13) on US-China optimism; reversed to 0.7158 on hot CPI and Moody's downgrade	PARTIALLY
GBPCAD	NEUTRAL	Broke decisively below 1.8430 range floor on May 15 (close 1.8376); May 18 low 1.8291; range call invalidated — bearish break confirmed	WRONG
XAGUSD	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	Spiked to 88.88 May 13 (wrong direction; +10.6% from May 8) then crashed -14.5% to 76.08; net direction bearish but timing badly off	PARTIALLY
XAUUSD	BEARISH	Gold rallied to 4,765 May 12 (exceeded 4,741 bias-flip trigger and stop at 4,680 on specific short); reversed to 4,545 on CPI and Moody's; specific SHORT was stopped out	PARTIALLY

TOP CONVICTION TRADES

#1 NAS100 LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
28,700-28,900	30,200	28,200

Year high 29,678 confirmed bullish price discovery. Moody's Mon-Tue dip creates re-entry below year high. NVDA Q1 earnings Thu May 22 is the dominant catalyst — AI capex narrative intact (Azure +29% YoY, hyperscaler build-out confirmed). NVDA historical beat rate 4 of last 4 quarters. Exit or hedge before NVDA print if not willing to take binary earnings risk. Risk-reward 1:2.7.

#2 GBPCAD SHORT

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
1.8380-1.8430	1.8200	1.8490

Broken support 1.8430 confirmed as resistance — three consecutive closes below. CAD supported by oil near \$100/bbl. BoE on hold at 3.75%. UK CPI Wed May 21: if inline or soft, confirms bearish break and 1.8200 measured-move target. If UK CPI hot (above 3.5%), cover shorts. Risk-reward 1:2.1. Stop tight above breakdown zone.

#3 XAUUSD LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
4,520-4,550	4,680	4,460

Moody's Aaa-to-Aa1 US downgrade is structurally dollar-negative and gold-positive. May 18 low 4,483 tested and held in early session — buyers present at support. Condition: INVALID if US 10-year yield rises above 4.60% (real yield headwind outweighs USD weakness) or if gold closes below 4,460 on any session. Risk-reward 1:2.1.

US30

Dow Jones Industrial Average

49,364

-322 · -0.65%

NEU-BEAR · -25

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
49,245 – 49,697	41,354 – 50,513	49,686	75%

SUPPORTS

S1

Prior weekly low — first defensive layer

49,085

S2

Apr 29 swing low

48,861

S3

Apr 29 intraday low — deeper structural

48,708

RESISTANCES

Psychological round number — just failed

R1

above

50,000

R2

May 14 intraday high

50,200

R3

All-time high Apr 22

50,512

ANALYSIS

Price action: US30 broke 50,000 on May 14 (high 50,200, close 50,063) — then reversed -537 pts on May 15 back to 49,526 as CPI fears and China visit disappointment weighed. Moody's downgrade adds further Monday pressure. Fundamentals: FOMC hold at 3.50-3.75%. CPI +3.8% removes any cut expectation. 10yr yield 4.544%. Moody's Aaa-to-Aa1. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell bounces 49,900-50,000 stop 50,150 target 49,085. Do not buy below 50,000 until yields stabilise.

NAS100

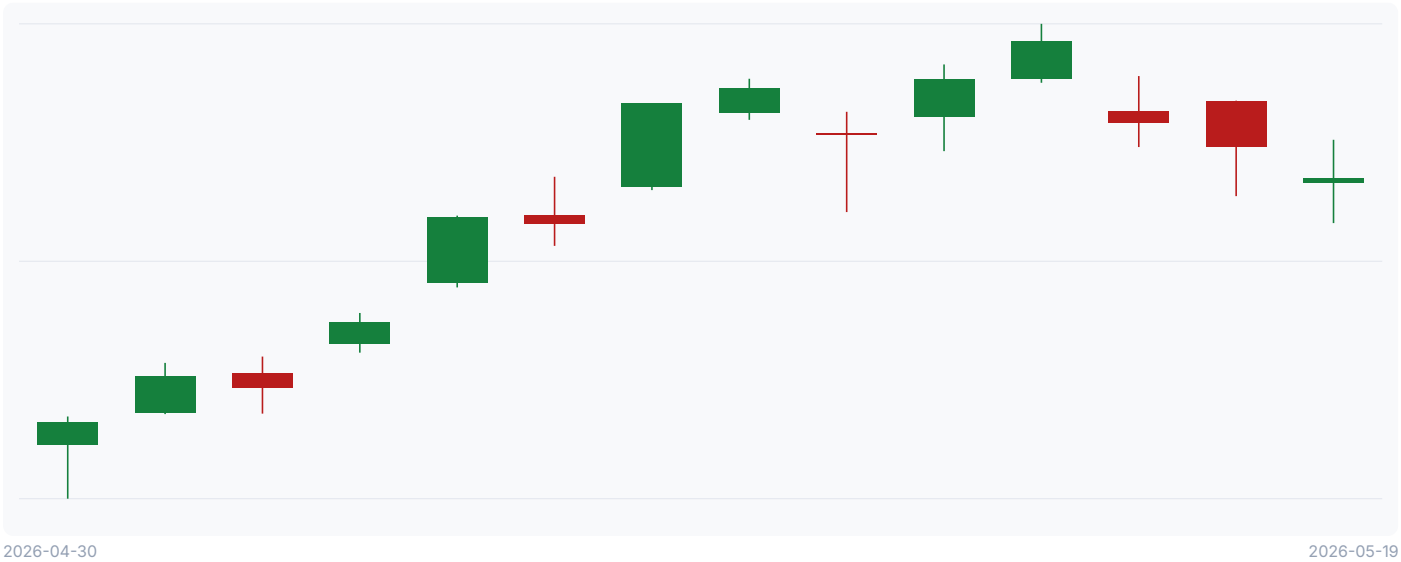
Nasdaq 100

28,819

-176 · -0.61%

NEU·BULL · +35

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
28,567 – 29,032	20,778 – 29,679	28,994	90%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES		
S1	May 12 low — near-term pivot	28,628	R1 May 13 intraday high	29,452
S2	Round number / breakdown level	28,200	R2 May 14 close	29,580
S3	May 1 close / prior consolidation area	27,710	R3 Year high May 14 — price discovery above	29,678

ANALYSIS

Price action: NAS100 hit year high 29,678 on May 14 on US-China trade optimism and AI capex momentum. Reversed -1.54% on May 15 on hot CPI and rising yields. Structure remains bullish above 28,628 support. Fundamentals: NVDA Q1 earnings Thu May 22 = dominant catalyst. AI capex narrative intact. 10yr yield 4.544% = headwind. Moody's dip = buy-the-dip entry. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BULLISH conditional on NVDA beat. Buy 28,700-28,900 stop 28,200 target 30,200. Do not hold through NVDA print without a plan for both outcomes.

GER40

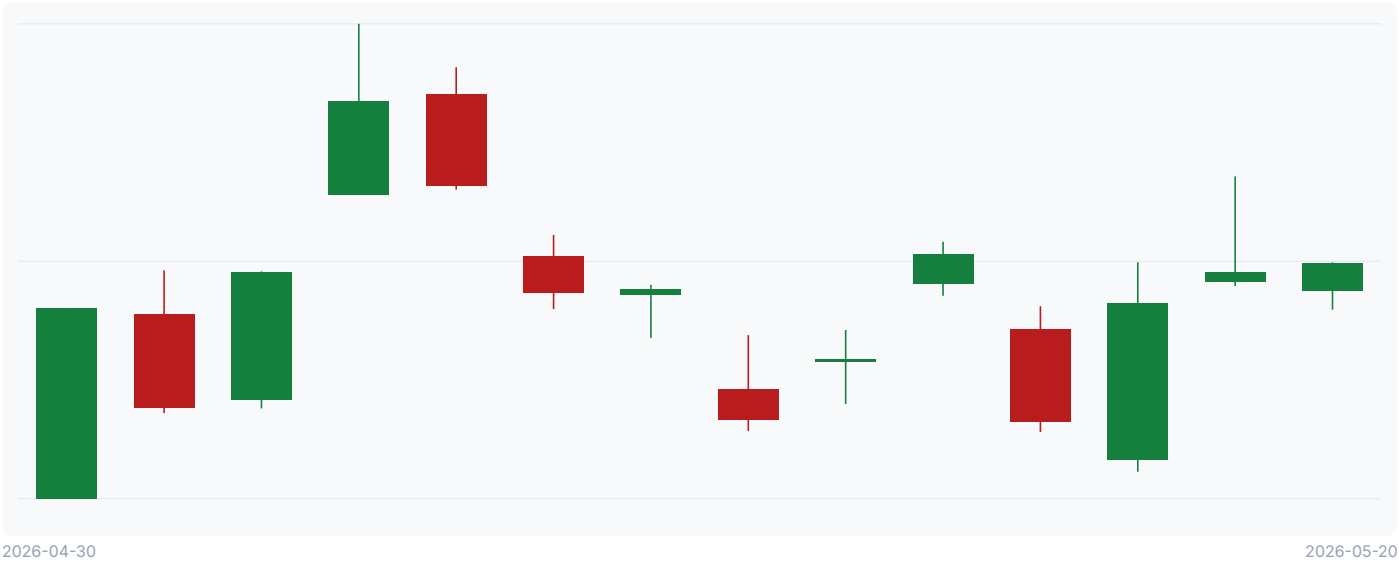
DAX Performance Index

24,428

-7 · -0.03%

NEU-BEAR · -40

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
24,288 – 24,431	21,864 – 25,508	24,435	70%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES	
S1	May 18 intraday low — must hold	23,797	R1 May 13 intraday high24,226
S2	Round number / structural support	23,500	R2 May 14 intraday high24,492
S3	Deeper prior consolidation	23,200	R3 May 6 high — year-high area25,152

ANALYSIS

Price action: GER40 fell -1.60% on the week from 24,338 to 23,950, continuing its downtrend from the 25,152 May 6 peak. Broke below 24,000 intraday May 18 (low 23,797) before recovering to 23,985. Fundamentals: ECB June 11 LIVE for hike. Global 10yr yield surge. Moody's adds risk premium. German industrial sector squeezed. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell rallies 24,200-24,300 stop 24,500 target 23,500. Break below 23,797 opens 23,500. Watch ECB speakers this week.

AUDUSD

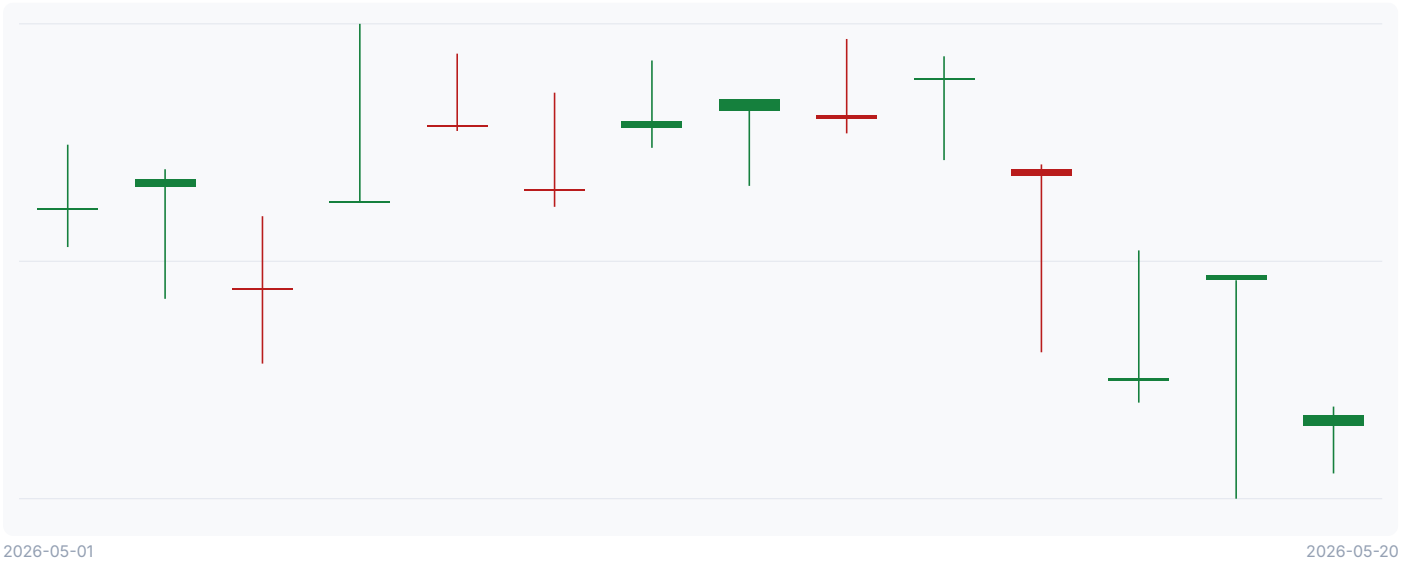
Australian Dollar vs US Dollar

0.7115

+0.0005 · +0.07%

NEU·BULL · +30

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
0.7091 – 0.7118	0.6374 – 0.7277	0.7110	75%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES		
S1	May 18 low — near-term pivot	0.7123	R1 May 15 intraday high	0.7219
S2	Psychological key floor	0.7100	R2 May 13 high	0.7271
S3	April low area	0.7050	R3 Year high May 6	0.7277

ANALYSIS

Price action: AUDUSD peaked at 0.7271 on May 13 (clearing 0.7200 target) on US-China trade optimism, then reversed to 0.7158 on hot CPI and Moody's downgrade. Fundamentals: RBA at 4.35% post-hike — rate divergence vs Fed (hold) is structurally AUD-positive. Moody's USD weakness is a tactical AUD tailwind. Hot CPI 3.8% = higher-for-longer USD = headwind. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BULLISH. Buy 0.7130-0.7150 stop 0.7095 target 0.7220. Below 0.7100 invalidates. Conditional on USD remaining under pressure from Moody's aftermath.

GBPCAD

British Pound vs Canadian Dollar

1.8430

+0.0021 · +0.11%

NEU·BEAR · -30

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
1.8396 – 1.8443	1.8018 – 1.8915	1.8409	80%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES	
S1	May 18 low1.8291	R1	Broken support — now firm resistance1.8430
S2	Structural support1.8200	R2	May 12 high1.8611
S3	52-week low1.8018	R3	52-week high1.8914

ANALYSIS

Price action: GBPCAD broke decisively below 1.8430 range floor on May 15 (close 1.8376). Broken support 1.8430 now confirmed as resistance. May 18 low 1.8291. Fundamentals: BoE hold 3.75%. UK CPI Wed May 21 = pivotal GBP catalyst. CAD bid from oil near \$100. BoC June 4 next CAD event. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell bounces 1.8390-1.8430 stop 1.8490 target 1.8200. UK CPI hot: cover shorts, reassess. UK CPI miss: 1.8200 confirmed target.

XAGUSD

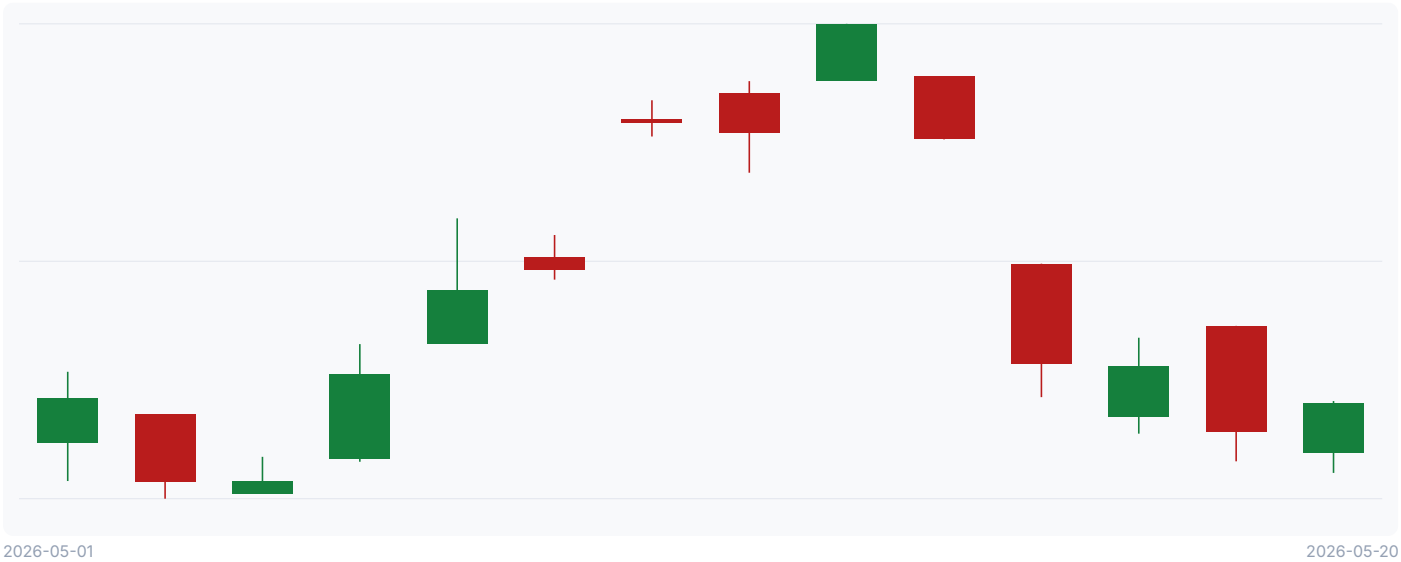
Silver Spot

75.80

+1.96 · +2.65%

NEU·BEAR · -45

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
73.39 – 75.87	32.66 – 121.30	73.85	65%

SUPPORTS	RESISTANCES
S1 May 18 intraday low — key near-term anchor 74.11	R1 May 15 open — prior breakdown point 80.61
S2 May 4 low 72.50	R2 May 14 close 84.91
S3 Apr 29 low — structural support 70.88	R3 May 13 period high — false breakout peak 88.88

ANALYSIS

Price action: Silver's extreme week — spiked to 88.88 (May 13) on US-China trade optimism and industrial demand narrative, then crashed -14.5% to 76.08 in two sessions on hot CPI + fading China deal + rising real yields. May 18 low 74.11. Fundamentals: Higher real yields = direct headwind. Industrial demand narrative over-priced pre-CPI. Moody's marginally supportive. Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Do not catch the falling knife. Sell bounces 79-80 stop 81.50 target 74.00. Wait for confirmed base at 74 before any long.

XAUUSD

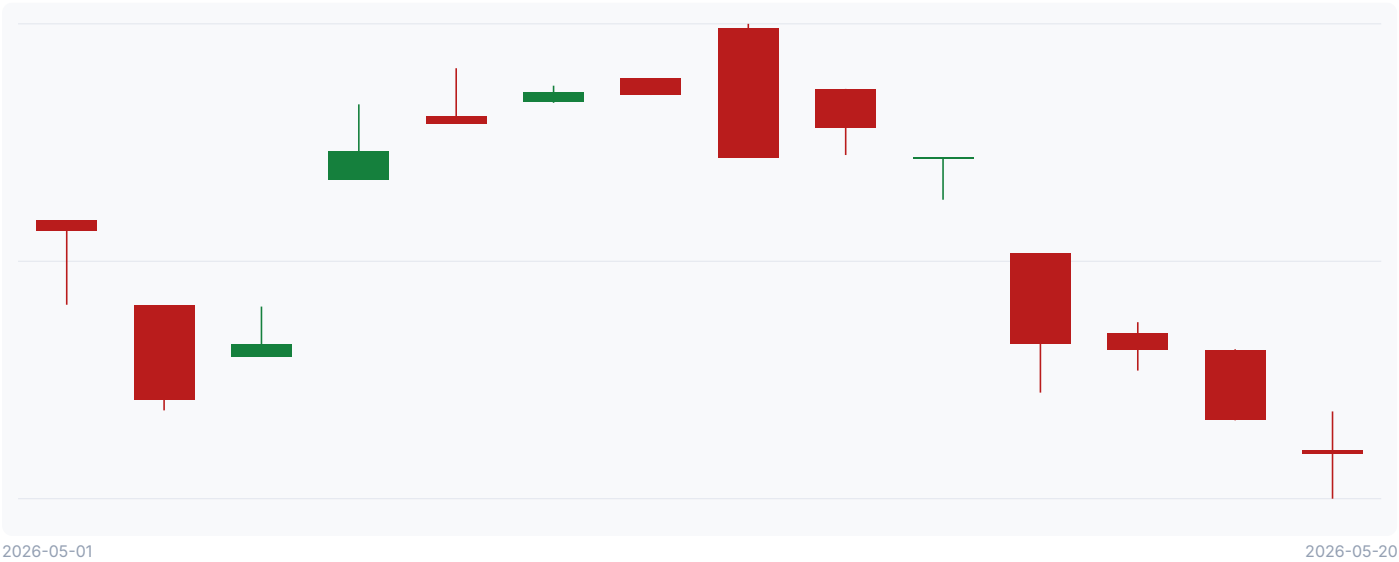
Gold Spot

4,484

+17 · +0.38%

NEUTRAL · +5

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
4,455 – 4,512	3,242 – 5,586	4,467	80%

SUPPORTS			RESISTANCES		
S1	May 18 intraday low — new pivotal anchor	4,483	R1	Round number	4,600
S2	Round number / structural support	4,400	R2	Prior broken support zone	4,650
S3	Deeper prior consolidation	4,300	R3	May 12 high	4,765

ANALYSIS

Price action: Gold peaked at 4,765 on May 12 on US-China trade optimism (cleared the 4,741 bias-flip trigger from tracking notes), then reversed to 4,545 on hot CPI and rising yields. May 18 tested 4,483 low before recovering. Two competing forces: Moody's downgrade (USD-negative, gold-positive) vs hot CPI / rising 10yr yield to 4.544% (real yield headwind). Outlook: 5-day NEUTRAL. Buy 4,520-4,550 stop 4,460 target 4,680 conditional on USD weakening on Moody's. Invalid if 10yr yield exceeds 4.60% or gold closes below 4,460.

UPCOMING EVENTS

DATE	TIME	EVENT	IMPACT
2026-05-18	All day	Moody's US downgrade Aaa-to-Aa1 market reaction — bonds, USD, gold	Very High
2026-05-19	Various	Fed speaker reactions post-downgrade and post-CPI	High
2026-05-20	06:00 GMT	UK Labour Market / Average Earnings	Medium
2026-05-21	06:00 GMT	UK CPI April	High
2026-05-22	After close	NVDA Q1 FY2027 Earnings	Very High
2026-05-23	08:00 GMT	Eurozone PMI Flash May	High
2026-05-23	08:30 GMT	UK PMI Flash May	High
2026-06-04	13:45 GMT	Bank of Canada Rate Decision	High
2026-06-11	12:15 GMT	ECB Rate Decision (LIVE for hike)	Very High

RISK SCENARIOS

Moody's Triggers Bond-Equity Cascade

20-25%

10yr yield breaks 4.70%, US30 -2 to -3%, NAS100 -3 to -5%, gold mixed (safe haven vs yield), AUDUSD -0.5 to -1%. Key transmission: yield spike compresses equity multiples. Invalidates Trade 1 and Trade 3.

NVDA Miss or Guide-Down (Thursday May 22)

15%

NAS100 -3 to -5% gap risk on earnings miss. US30 -1 to -2%. AI capex narrative unwinds. Year-high breakout negated. Invalidates Trade 1. Trade 2 (GBPCAD SHORT) and Trade 3 (XAUUSD) unaffected.

Hot UK CPI (above 3.5%) Wednesday May 21

30%

GBP spike +0.5 to +1% vs CAD — GBPCAD recovers to 1.8430-1.8500. Trade 2 GBPCAD SHORT stopped out. BoE rate expectations reprice higher. GBP also firms vs USD. Probability elevated by stickiness in UK services CPI.

Moody's USD Weakness Drives Gold Recovery

35%

Dollar index falls 0.5 to 1.0% on Moody's digestion. Gold recovers from 4,545 toward 4,650-4,700. AUDUSD extends to 0.7200+. This is Trade 3 base case. Historical precedent: S&P 2011 US downgrade saw gold rally strongly in the aftermath.

ECB Hawkish Pre-Commitment for June 11

25%

ECB governing council member signals June 11 hike in public remarks. EUR +0.5 to +1%, GER40 -1.5 to -2%. Validates GER40 NEUTRAL-BEARISH bias. Eurozone CPI 3.0% plus sticky services CPI keeps this live.